

Great hall
The castle was the fortified manor house of a wealthy man, and as such had its hall designed in the finest contemporary fashion, with Gothic arched windows.



Sturdy walls
Window embrasures reveal the impressive thickness of the castle's outer walls. The needs of defence dictated that outer openings be kept small, making for a sombre interior.



Fine ceiling
The castle's inner chambers boasted elaborately vaulted ceilings. Such decoration was another display of the owner's wealth and refined taste.



Stone interior
The castle buildings were hard to heat. The stone floors were strewn with rushes, straw, or herbs and tapestries bedecked the walls.

Fairy-tale castle
Aesthetics were as important in the design of Bodiam as military considerations. It was consciously built to fulfil the ideal of a beautiful castle as described in medieval romances.





Machicolations
Openings known as machicolations between the corbels of a projecting battlement allowed the defenders to drop missiles onto an enemy beneath. These machicolations are in the gatehouse.



Loophole
The walls are dotted with loopholes and arrow-slits to allow defenders to shoot outwards. This one is in the lower gatehouse wall.



Round tower
The corner towers were an excellent vantage point from which to observe the surrounding countryside. Their curved surfaces deflected missiles hurled by siege engines.



Inner chambers
Smaller structures within the castle walls provided accommodation for the knight's household and storerooms for weapons and armour.